

Peter Bartsch

(847) 636-2708 | peter@peterbartsch.com | portfolio: peterbartsch.com | linkedin.com/in/peterbartsch

Staff / Principal Product Designer — design systems · AI-native workflow. Led UX for a \$3.8B platform at Deere across web, mobile, and embedded equipment systems (500K users, 12 languages). Built design org 1→10 at FourKites scaling a real-time IoT asset-tracking platform processing 10M+ daily events (\$3M→\$100M ARR, \$1B+ valuation). Now founder of Thios — running an AI-native workflow (Claude, Cursor, Figma Make) to ship a CAD-driven configurator, a dev-grade design system with its own Claude Skill, and physical hardware.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

THIOS (thios.co) | Founder & Lead Designer Aug 2024 – Present

Open-source modular structures — solo designer, AI-augmented engineering team, 6-surface design system from one source of truth.

- Shipped a complete product ecosystem solo — 6 sphere variants with CAD models, prototype, and first revenue across every surface.
- Designed and built parametric OnShape CAD as the single source of truth driving BOM and the 3D configurator at thios.co/configurator — customers manipulate real geometry with full configuration state (valid/invalid combinations, loading, error, empty, BOM hand-off), not marketing renders.
- Built a 6-surface, dev-grade design system and published its first Claude Skill (`audit-design-token-drift`) — catches design-token drift across canonical surfaces with file:line citations. Design system as dev tooling, not a Figma library nobody opens — thios.co/design-system-architecture.html

JOHN DEERE | Senior Lead UX; Digital Customer Experience Aug 2020 – Jul 2024

Embedded with product teams to modernize 20-year-old systems and drive connected-services revenue across agricultural equipment.

- Redesigned the license management system for connected ag equipment (Automation/AI services) serving 500K+ users across 12 languages — mapped flows, license states, and edge cases (expired/renewed/transferred/dealer-managed); profile completion 34%→87%, -16% support tickets, enabled \$3.8B in connected-services revenue.
- Reduced design-to-development time 45% by building the first dev-ready tokens, prop specs, and full state coverage for the enterprise design system in Figma spanning 6 brands and 40+ product teams globally — handoffs that shipped.
- Built a unified account and navigation framework deployed across 8 product lines spanning web, mobile, and embedded equipment systems — consolidated fragmented experiences into a single customer view; +28% first-contact resolution on dealer support.

FOURKITES | Lead UX / Manager Jan 2017 – Jan 2020

Employee #28 during hypergrowth, \$3M → \$100M ARR (\$1B+ valuation). Built the design function from scratch — founding designer to a 10-person global team.

- Designed flagship IoT asset-tracking platform 0→1 — real-time supply chain control tower (web) and mobile apps processing 10M+ daily GPS/telematics events for 30+ Fortune 2000 customers (Anheuser-Busch, Georgia-Pacific, Tyson); high-density dashboards with map, list, and timeline views became the primary driver of 3x customer expansion.
- Led predictive analytics dashboards (data viz, anomaly states, alerting workflows) that identified shipment delays 6–12 hours earlier than competitors; +41% retention, +\$120K avg ACV.
- Scaled the design org across Chicago and Chennai embedded in engineering sprint cadence; established component library, design ops, and hiring framework; -65% one-off component variants while maintaining startup velocity.

MAVENWAVE PARTNERS | Senior UX + Agile Lead Jan 2014 – Jan 2017

Led digital product design for Fortune 500 healthcare and pharma clients.

- Designed 6 internal portals for AbbVie supporting 200K+ users across clinical trials and patient support programs — improved medication adherence tracking, -12% hospital readmissions.
- Rebuilt OptumRx pharmacy formulary platform processing 1.4B prescriptions annually; created the company's first patient-facing product — -15% drug-interaction-related fulfillment errors.
- Established Lean UX and Agile/sprint-cadence practices across client engagements while mentoring junior designers and leading cross-functional design sprints.

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EARLIER EXPERIENCE

NOKIA / HERE MAPS | Product Marketing Manager, HERE Traffic | GPS probe visualizations, real-time vehicle-telematics data products, and go-to-market for DEMPSY (open-source distributed computing). Aug 2012 – Jan 2014

GOGO INFLIGHT INTERNET | Product Manager – Signature Services | Launched in-flight internet across major US airlines; onboard hardware UX + Air-to-Ground RF network; FAA-approved documentation; 0→1 in-flight tracker driving sponsorship deals. Apr 2008 – Aug 2012

SKILLS

UX Systems: User flows · journey mapping · IA · interaction design · state management · edge-case coverage (idle/loading/success/error/empty) · information density · dashboards · enterprise design systems · design tokens · accessibility (WCAG 2.1)

Research & Methods: User interviews · usability testing · design sprints · Lean UX · Agile/Scrum sprint cadence · PRD/RFC participation

AI-Native Workflow: Claude (incl. authoring custom Claude Skill) · Cursor · Figma Make · Adobe Firefly · Midjourney · Obsidian as knowledge base

Tools: Figma · OnShape CAD · Blender 3D · HTML/CSS · Adobe Creative Suite

EDUCATION

Arizona State University | Bachelor of Arts, Humanities and Architectural Theory

COMMUNITY

Member, Board of Directors | How Weird Street Faire 501(c)(3), San Francisco | 2000 – 2024